

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 12, 2022, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward II Councilor James Contois
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Lucas Beliveau (on the phone, home, alone)
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Lisa Richmond, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to accept the minutes of the December 8, 2021, City Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - abstain

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0, with 1 abstain.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the December 14, 2021, City Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - abstain

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0, with 1 abstain.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept the minutes of the December 21, 2021, City Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - abstain

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - abstain

Girard - yes

Motion carried 7-0, with 2 abstentions.

Since the Councilors had not stated, Mr. MacLean asked why they were abstaining from voting. Both, Councilors Stone and Mooshian, said they were not present at those respective meetings.

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard’s notes:

- Warming shelters are the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center and the Fiske Free Library (during open hours).
- December 16th, Public Works picked up the kiosks from Sugar River Valley Regional Technical Center. They will be installed at the reservoirs in the spring. Mayor Girard commended the students for all the work and the great job they did.
- Talked about Parks and Recreation Director Mark Brislin’s Monthly Report and the First Night Events. Mayor Girard thanked everyone who put this on, especially Mr. Brislin for all of his efforts.

Proclamation for Marcie St. Pierre and Chris Pixley Retirements

Mayor Girard presented a proclamation to Chris Pixley, Fire Captain, in honor of his retirement from the Claremont Fire Department after twenty-five years of service. Fire Chief Bryan Burr thanked Captain Pixley.

Mayor Girard presented a proclamation to Marcy St. Pierre, Communications & Records Manager, in honor of her retirement from the Claremont Police Department after almost twenty-five years of service. Police Chief Mark Chase thanked her for her service and said she will come back on a part-time basis. Ms. St. Pierre gave thanks for the friendships she has developed over the years.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

John MacLean, Interim City Manager, said this is his second day on the job. Previously, he had spent nine months at the City of Claremont. He talked about the Mayor's inaugural address and that Mayor Girard said that we are all on the same team: City Council, City Staff and Claremont citizens. We all want Claremont to succeed.

Mr. MacLean said the employees are the greatest assets. The employees have held the pieces together for years. Currently, organizational capacity in Claremont is at an all-time low. What we can do and how we can do it is affected by the numbers of people that we have and what they are already doing. We don't have a "next person up." We don't have succession planning. This is a real issue for the City and is something we should be working on. There is a lot of institutional memory leaving with retirements. He has the beginning of an outline on how he would like to approach this. He will work with the Finance Director on a financial review in the near future to determine the financial position of the City. The City has an austere approach to how it budgets. We want to attract young professionals to the City. We want to be competitive in the market to bring in those young professionals and it is important for them to succeed here.

Mr. MacLean said within the team there are some great individuals. He would like to recognize Police Chief Mark Chase as Assistant City Manager. He has been acting in the capacity from time-to-time and Mr. MacLean would like to make this more formalized. Mr. MacLean will not be here every day, so he will be leaning on Chief Chase. Mr. MacLean will authorize a 10% stipend for Chief Chase. Also, he will be looking at a stipend for Fire Chief Bryan Burr for his work in operating the Airport. Mr. MacLean said that Dorée Russell, Executive Assistant and Clerk to the Council, who was going to retire at the end of January, will remain an additional two months, and he has offered an extension bonus, which will not be a burden on the City. In addition, he wants to work with Alex Gleeson, Public Works Director, in terms of career development, with an outside contractor. Community development can be controversial, because there is a certain element of risk in these projects. He has worked with many communities and he said that Claremont has one of the best community development directors in the state, Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director. He and Ms. Merrill will give the Council a

presentation to show what has been happening in Claremont. He said he hopes this will be acceptable to the Council. He was not looking for a vote, but is open to hear any Councilor's concern over the next few days.

Mr. MacLean said the City has received notice that power outages could occur in the future. He wanted to assure the Council that if that were to happen, that there is an emergency management plan in place.

Emergency Management Director/Fire Chief Bryan Burr talked about the notice that had been received from Eversource regarding ISO-New England's (operator of the region's power grid) announcement that fuel supply issues could affect its ability to meet demand for electricity this winter. If the area experiences extended periods of extreme cold weather and at the same time, power plant fuel supplies are constrained, emergency actions may have to be taken in order to safeguard the stability of the power, including local conservation, voltage reduction, and finally rolling blackouts. Chief Burr said that the water and sewer plants are prepared for this and could last a few days if that were to happen. He said that every effort would be made to notify the City and the public in advance, if possible.

Francis Gauthier Ward 1, said he's been posting for quite a while that we need community power as the power from the grid is unreliable. He asked why not community power, and why it has been put off. He said this is a perfect example.

Chief Burr said the Emergency Action Plan is available on the Fire Department's webpage.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Councilor Koloski said he wanted to look at the committees and to permanently sunset some of them. He doesn't like that information goes back and forth between the committee and the Council. He would rather it go directly to the Council so that the Council, as a whole, can make the decisions.

Assistant Mayor Matteau said that the Finance Committee was sunsetted in 2021.

Councilor Koloski said that some of the committees have not produced enough in order to continue on. Assistant Mayor Matteau agreed with Councilor Koloski that it is more efficient to deal with things head on. There has been a lot of money spent by committees on legal opinions. She would rather have information brought to the Council for decisions to be made. She said some of the committees are dragging things out and she doesn't think that is efficient. Councilor Koloski said that the Energy Advisory Committee is one. They don't publish agendas for their meeting. Community aggregation needs to be discussed by the Council. Mayor Girard said this can be placed on the next agenda under New Business for discussion.

Mr. MacLean said it may be helpful to establish criteria for how the Council would go about sunseting a committee (i.e. whether or not they've met, how long it's been). He suggested

Councilors may want to submit those criteria to the Mayor for further review when they talk about the committees.

Airport Advisory Board

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Allyn Girard to seat 1 of the Airport Advisory Board.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Claremont Planning Board

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Dakin Burdick to seat 1, of the Claremont Planning Board.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Claremont Police Commission

A motion was made by Councilor Beliveau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Scott Kirkpatrick to seat 2 of the Claremont Police Commission.

Councilor Beliveau withdrew his motion and Councilor Stone withdrew his second.

Councilors made the following nominations for appointment to seat 2 of the Claremont Police Commission.

- **Councilor Beliveau nominated Scott Kirkpatrick**
- **Councilor Koloski nominated Donald B. Fontaine, Jr.**
- **Councilor Contois nominated Alison Raymond for re-appointment**

Councilor Koloski thanked Ms. Raymond for her time serving on the Claremont Police Commission. He said he knows Mr. Fontaine for his service. He made a comment about the Council not getting to meet the applicants.

Scott Kirkpatrick was in attendance and was asked to speak to the Council. He said he grew up in Claremont, and he gave some background including that he was a police officer in Arizona.

Roll call vote:

Contois - Raymond

O'Hearne - Kirkpatrick

Stone - Kirkpatrick

Matteau - Fontaine

Koloski - Kirkpatrick

Limoges - Kirkpatrick

Beliveau - Kirkpatrick

Mooshian - Raymond

Girard - Kirkpatrick

Motion carried 6 votes for Scott Kirkpatrick; 2 votes for Alison Raymond; and 1 vote for Donald B. Fontaine, Jr.

Parks and Recreation Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Raymond Hughes, III, to seat A5 – At-Large, of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board – Downtown

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to re-appoint Robert Porter to seat 5, Member At-Large, of the Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board – Downtown.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Trustees of Trust Funds

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to re-appoint Marilyn Harris to seat 3 of the Trustees of Trust Funds.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Policy Committee

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Mooshian to re-appoint Bonnie Miles to seat 5 of the Policy Committee.

Councilor Koloski said this board semi-works. Councilor Stone said the Policy Committee has a viable use in researching ordinances.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Finance Committee

Ryan Kelly had applied to be appointed to seat 4 of the Finance Committee.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to disband the Finance Committee.

Assistant Mayor Matteau said she doesn’t believe the Finance Committee has met in quite some time. She believes the information that was being sent to the Finance Committee can be brought before the Council for resolution.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Claremont Energy Advisory Committee

Applications had been submitted to re-appoint Rebecca MacKenzie to seat 1; re-appoint David Lucier to seat 2; re-appoint Jessica Ball to seat 5; appoint Francis Gauthier to seat A1; and re-appoint Marilyn Harris to seat A2.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne, for discussion, to disband the Claremont Energy Advisory Committee.

Councilor Contois said this Council doesn’t have time to look into the complex issues that this committee and the Electric Aggregation Committee work on. He doesn’t see the advantage of disbanding them. They’ve done good work and he would like to see that continue.

Councilor Koloski said he has watched those meetings and looked at what they’ve been tasked with and he feels the committee is not needed.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Stone to table this to the next meeting for further discussion.

Roll call vote:

Contois - no

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - no

Girard - no

Motion carried 5-4.

Electric Aggregation Committee

An application had been submitted to appoint Francis Gauthier to seat 4 of the Electric Aggregation Committee.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to table this to the January 26, 2022, Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Contois - no

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - no

Girard - no

Motion carried 5-4.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES (CITY COUNCIL BOARD ASSIGNMENTS)

Airport Advisory Board (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Mayor Dale Girard to the City Council Representative seat of the Airport Advisory Board.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Claremont Community Television, Inc. (CCTV) Board of Directors (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor Andrew O’Hearne to seat 1, City Council Representative, of the Claremont Community Television, Inc. (CCTV) Board of Directors.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Claremont Energy Advisory Committee (Councilor Seat(s))

Claremont Energy Advisory Committee tabled to the January 26th meeting.

Claremont Planning Board (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau to seat 9, City Councilor, of the Claremont Planning Board.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

A nomination was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Councilor Nicholas Koloski to seat A5, City Council Alternate, of the Claremont Planning Board.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - abstain

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0, with 1 abstain.

Conservation Commission (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to appoint Councilor James Contois to seat 7, City Council Representative, of the Conservation Commission.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Electric Aggregation Committee (Councilor Seat(s))

Electric Aggregation Committee tabled to the January 26th meeting.

Historic District Commission (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Mooshian to appoint Councilor James Contois to seat 2, City Council Representative, of the Historic District Commission.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Policy Committee (Councilor Seat(s))

A nomination was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor William Limoges to seat 1 of the Policy Committee.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - abstain
Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstain.

A nomination was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor Andrew O’Hearne to seat 2 of the Policy Committee.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

A nomination was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to appoint Councilor Stone to seat 3 of the Policy Committee.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Finance Committee (Councilor Seat(s))

In a previous motion during this meeting, Council voted to disband the Finance Committee.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Francis Gauthier, Ward 1, said he noticed when Chief Burr talked about rolling blackouts that the Council was not alarmed. He agreed with Councilor Koloski to get rid of those two committees. There was talk of bringing in charging station(s), but he said when you have a problem with capacity, the last thing you want is charging stations. He said they wouldn’t be

used. He would recommend putting people on those committees who want to get things done. He asked why community power hasn't gone forward. He said you would buy power from the ISO power pool. He said when he was at the Statehouse, he had asked why we weren't getting more Hydro Quebec. He asked why the community isn't demanding that we buy from Hydro Quebec. He talked about hydro generators on the Sugar River and solar farms. He said the solar farms are sending power to Massachusetts, but the power should stay here. He said a crisis is coming and this Council must act.

Barbara Smith, Ward 3, said that Paddy Hollow Road had been maintained for 30 years and last year they just stopped. She's been there 32 years. According to the RSA, if you've maintained a road for more than 5 years, you own it. There are three residents up past her. She would like to have it looked into, otherwise she'll go to court.

Mr. MacLean said he will look into that and will contact Ms. Smith and let the Council know the result. As he just started here, it may take a couple of weeks to get up to speed.

OLD BUSINESS

Claremont Country Club Discretionary Easement – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to take this off the table.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Mr. MacLean said this is a public policy issue. We are talking about open space and we are talking about a Discretionary Easement. Open space is not something the City has put a lot of effort into. The City has put a lot of emphasis on development. Open space is an aspect of quality of life.

Bob McCarthy, Contract Assessor, gave a summary. He said the Claremont Country Club (CCC) does qualify legally for a discretionary easement. It was done previously, but was allowed to expire. The tax reduction would be \$5,634.75. The tax difference would account for a rate change of less than \$0.01, rounding for calculation purposes.

Mayor Girard opened the public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

Joe Trabka, CCC Chairman of the Board, referenced last month's Council meeting and said that Walpole owns the land that the golf course is on; Hanover is out of business, but was owned by Dartmouth College; and Bretton Wood in Keene receives an 80-85% discount. The CCC has been a member of this community for over 150 years. The CCC is the home course for the high school team and the junior high team. In the summer, they teach kids to play golf. This program is affiliated with First Tee. They've added soccer golf to the course. Regarding shifting the tax burden to the elderly, they have about 160 members and he estimates that about 100 of them are over 65 years old. Many have been members for a number of years and this golf course helps keep them in the community. He asked the Council to vote in favor of this Discretionary Easement.

Mr. McCarthy said the greens, tees, fairways, rough, and the land under them are affected by the value change. The parking, Country Club, and commercial curtilage are not included.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 79-C:2, III, hereby authorizes the assessment of the public golf course located at 53 Country Club Road (Map 142 Lot 2) at fifty percent of the full value assessment of the land, as reflecting the public benefit conferred by the property under criteria set forth in RSA 79-C:2, III. The City Council further authorizes the City Manager or his designees to enter into and record a discretionary preservation easement for the qualifying land, as approved by action of the City Council on January 12, 2022.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

City Manager Transition Update

Mayor Girard said this is a City Manager recruitment update. He said he had talked to Alan Gould, MRI, who said he has heard from six Councilors, and by Friday, he hoped to hear from all.

Mayor Girard said tonight the Council needs to discuss the salary range. In 2016, it was \$135,000, with benefits it was in the \$145,000 range. Using a 2% increase, the range would be \$150,000-\$155,000. There is a shortage of city managers and if the City expects to bring in a seasoned veteran, the City needs to be willing to pay appropriately.

After a brief discussion, most of the Councilors were comfortable with the \$155,000 range.

Mayor Girard said that MRI (Municipal Resources, Inc.) offered to set up an email for this process. The emails will go directly to MRI. Councilors agreed that MRI should open that email address and make it available to everyone.

Mayor Girard talked about the City Manager residency requirement in the Charter. There is a housing shortage in Claremont. The public needs to make the change to the Charter. Mayor Girard said that Councilor Stone reached out to NHMA (NH Municipal Association) for information regarding a Charter change. Mayor Girard said that Mr. MacLean is reaching out to the City Clerk regarding this matter. Mr. MacLean said he is working with the City Clerk to develop a timeline. Any legal language would have to go through the City's attorney.

Councilor Koloski asked if a residency requirement has legally been challenged. He is in favor of residency, however, he said there are only four residences listed for sale in Claremont.

Assistant Mayor Matteau is in favor of the City Manager living here, but would hate to lose a qualified candidate because of that requirement.

Councilor Stone wants to limit a Charter change to this one issue.

Mr. MacLean said he knows the residency requirement has successfully been challenged for other employees. He said he would look into it, but his guess is that we would need the Charter change.

Mayor Girard recommended continuing to work on this and bring back an update. At the same time, we can look for a legal opinion.

Mayor Girard said it appears the majority of the Council is in favor going forward with the Charter change.

NEW BUSINESS

EV Charging Station Grant

Mr. MacLean gave a brief introduction.

Ms. Merrill talked about the time it would take to charge an electric vehicle at home (2-3 days) versus at a fast-charging station (1-2 hours). Three locations have been identified (Wall Street,

North Street Parking Lot, and Broad Street) and Eversource is reviewing those sites. The Wall Street area would require a little less work and fewer parking spaces. There is no cost to the taxpayer. It would require some public parking spaces. The state will select one location for every 20 miles.

There will be no cost to install, maintain or operate this.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski that the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designee to enter into a partnership with a qualified technical vendor to submit at least one EV charging station installation proposal in city owned parking sites to the NH Department of Environmental Services in response to the NH Volkswagen Mitigation Trust Electric Vehicle Charging Station RFP. If a proposal is selected the City Council authorizes the City Manager or his designee to enter into an agreement with the vendor to install, maintain and operate the charging station at no cost to the City of Claremont.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Sale of City-Owned Land

Information from Ms. Merrill:

We have received recent inquiries on several city owned properties and reviewed previous notes and recommendations on the parcels, and would like to recommend that the City Council authorize placing the following parcels for bid:

Hanover Street, Map 108-Lot 11.

This is a 7841 square foot lot, or .18 acres, on a slope off Hanover Street surrounded by residential buildings. The city demolished a house at that location in 2004. It is in the Professional Residential zone.

North Street, Map 107-Lot 340

This is a 13,504 square foot level lot, or .31 acres, on North Street surrounded by residential buildings. It is in the Professional Residential zone.

Elm Street, Map 107-Lot 237

This lot is also in a Professional Residential zone. It is a level parcel of 7405 square feet, or .17 acres, with a vacant parcel to the north and residential parcel to the south.

Off Old Church Road, Map 81-Lot 56

This is a 32-acre parcel that runs along the Sugar River south of the Coy paper mill dam. It is zoned residential 1 (R-1). Coy Paper Co. applied for an 11-parcel subdivision on 12 acres of this parcel in 1976 which was approved and recorded but never built. The city has a main sewer line through the parcel so any sale would be contingent on a buyer giving an access and maintenance easement to the city for the sewer line (see attached map). Floodplain and stream bank overlays are minimal impacts (see attached map). It could be utilized as a single lot or a buyer could take advantage of the existing subdivision with changes related to the sewer easement and any new shoreland or zoning regulations.

Mr. MacLean reviewed the list of City-owned properties.

Ms. Merrill said the property Off Old Church Road is a 32-acre parcel, but the memo says .32 acres. There is main sewer trunk line that runs through that parcel and there would have to be a 100-foot easement for the sewer line.

Councilor Koloski thinks it is important that Councilors see the entire list of properties that the City owns and the reasons they are held by the City. He asked about public notices. Ms. Merrill said they are posted in the newspaper. She said they can be listed for sale or auction, such as what was done for the Goodwin Community Center, but a lot of people are not happy with that outcome. The larger parcel would be sent out to some who are interested in housing. It will all come back to the Council for conditions. She said the City has always looked at use first and price second. Some of these lots are not buildable. She said she and the City Manager would negotiate on the City's behalf. Mr. MacLean said the City reserves the right to not accept bids.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne that the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to post a public bid for the sale of city owned land located at Tax Map 108, Lot 11 (Hanover Street), Tax Map 107, Lot 340 (North Street), Tax Map 107, Lot 237 (Elm Street) and Tax Map 81, Lot 56 (Old Church Rd).

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2022-14 LCHIP Grant for Opera House Windows – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City Council by motion approved on April 28, 2021, authorized the city manager, or his designees, to apply for a Land and Community Heritage Investment Program (LCHIP) grant for the purpose of City Hall window restoration (the Project); and

WHEREAS the City has been awarded the LCHIP Grant in the amount of up to \$91,000.00 to undertake the Project; and

WHEREAS the City would now like to expend said LCHIP grant funds for their intended purpose; and

WHEREAS the City is required to provide \$92,000.00 in matching funds;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council raise, appropriate and expend up to \$183,000.00, with up to \$91,000.00 to be received from LCHIP grant funds, and up to \$92,000.00 to come from fund balance (to have no impact on the tax rate), for the purpose of repairing and restoring City Hall windows; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Mr. MacLean said the building windows need this. This will help defray some of the cost.

Ms. Merrill said this was put into the CIP (Capital Improvements Plan) for a two-year project. She acknowledged the work done on this by Maintenance Supervisor Bill Willette and Claremont Opera House (COH) Executive Director Andrew Pinard. She said the first funding will go toward the worst windows. This requires a 50% match.

Mr. Pinard talked about some leaded glass windows, not knowing if they were included in the inventory or included in the work, that the COH did \$40,000 worth of work on. Half the money was from the Moose Grant and the other half was from the COH. The total cost for that was estimated to be \$114,000 which would cover 13 of the leaded glass windows. He said the COH fully supports this project. They are looking for funds to add to the \$20,000 Moose Plate Grant they are about to receive.

Ms. Merrill said this building is on the National Register of Historic Places and all but three of the windows in this building are original. So, this is a major restoration project for City Hall.

Mayor Girard opened the public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Koloski to adopt Resolution 2022-14 LCHIP Grant for Opera House Windows.

Councilor O’Hearne read the resolution into the record

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Authorization to Purchase Council Chambers Chairs

Over the years, some of the chairs around the Council table have broken and required repair.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau that the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designee to purchase chairs for Council Chambers not to exceed \$2,500, with \$1,900 to come from FY2021 encumbered funds and the remainder to come from Misc Expenses – Council Requests.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mayor Girard said he hopes that Councilors will bring back reports from their committees.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski said that over the years that it has been requested that Council and School Board not schedule meetings on the same nights. He suggested maybe we could add School Board meetings to the City Calendar.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:06 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council